

Speech and Language

Emerging evidence base · 12–15 minutes

This version: For people who picture things easily (visual)

Read slowly — about 30–45 seconds per paragraph. There is no hurry.

OPENING · BREATH AND LIGHT

Find a position where you can be still and comfortable. Sitting is fine. Lying down is fine. Let your hands rest wherever they fall, without holding anything.

When you are ready, allow your eyes to close — or let your gaze soften toward the floor, if that feels more natural.

Begin simply by noticing that you are breathing. Not changing anything yet. Just noticing — the small rise and fall, the slight pause at the top, the release.

As you continue to notice, the breath may begin, on its own, to slow and deepen. Not because you are forcing it. Simply because you are paying attention, and the body tends to settle when it is noticed.

With each breath out, there is a softening. In the jaw. In the shoulders. In the throat — that part of you that holds tension when communication feels difficult. Let the throat soften now, as if it were warming from the inside.

And with each breath in, there is a warmth gathering at the centre of the chest. With each breath out, it spreads slowly upward: into the throat, into the base of the skull, into the face, into the back of the head. Not urgently. Simply spreading, as warmth does, in its own time.

Allow three or four more breaths here — unhurried — and let each breath out carry a little more of whatever tension you arrived with. There is nothing else required of you right now. Nowhere else to be.

PHASE ONE · THE IDEAL BEING

A figure begins to appear in front of you, at a comfortable distance. Whoever this figure is for you is right — a face you know, or no face at all. What you notice is that they are at ease. Settled. Their breath is slow, their shoulders soft. They are in a conversation with someone — someone familiar, or simply a companion. Take a moment to see the room they are in. The light. The chairs. The unhurried feel of it.

Watch them speak. The words arrive when they reach for them. The sound forms in the throat and moves through the mouth without strain. The jaw and the tongue move without having to be told. The person with them hears them, and understands. Watch the ease of it — the absence of

tightening, the breath continuing normally rather than held in anticipation. Watch how communication looks when it is not effortful.

Once more. The figure says something small — a name, perhaps, or a single word — and it comes. Not forced. Simply found. Notice the quality of it. The unhurried rhythm. The way one word follows another.

Now the figure moves toward you. Closer. And steps into you. You are no longer apart from it. Their throat is your throat. Their breath is your breath. From the inside: the ease in the jaw, the tongue resting and ready, the breath moving evenly beneath the words. You are speaking, and being understood. Perhaps you say something — a name, or a word you have been reaching for. And it comes. Not because you forced it — because you allowed the system to find it. Yours.

Stay here a moment, inside this. Not grasping at it. Simply noticing it is possible — that this is a version of you that exists, even now, even in fragments.

If it shifts or dissolves, that is fine. Allow it. Return gently to the breath and to the ease in the throat, the jaw, the chest. This is enough.

PHASE TWO · THE ANATOMICAL PATHWAY

Now we travel a pathway together. This is a journey from intention to sound — from the part of you that knows what you want to say, through to the structures that form the words in the world.

Begin with attention in the left side of your head — the left hemisphere. Somewhere behind the left temple, in the frontal part of the brain, is a region that has helped you find words your whole life. It is still there. Still capable. This practice is one way of speaking to it — of reminding it of what it knows.

There is a small pulse of warmth in that area. The intention to speak. Not the sound yet. Just the intention. The choosing of a word.

Now follow that intention as it moves. Deeper into the left side of the brain — through a narrow passage called the internal capsule — a pathway as fine as a thread, carrying the signal that will become speech.

The signal moves downward, through the base of the brain, through the brainstem — the part that does not sleep, that keeps the heartbeat, that manages the voice. Here, the signal branches.

One branch reaches the tongue — through the nerve that runs beneath the skull and curves down toward the floor of the mouth. That nerve warm and conducting. The tongue receiving the signal, knowing its position, knowing the shape it needs to make.

Another branch reaches the lips, the cheeks, the face — through the facial nerve, which fans across the face like a small river delta. The lips softening, ready.

Another reaches the soft palate at the back of the mouth — the structure that closes off the nasal passage as you speak, that shapes the resonance of sound.

And below all of this, the breath — the diaphragm and the muscles between the ribs — receiving their own signal, coordinating the stream of air that carries every word.

All of this, happening in less than a heartbeat. All of this, still here.

Let your attention rest in the whole system now. Not any single part. The sense of an intention moving from brain to breath to sound, fluidly, without interference.

And if it helps, you might imagine speaking a word. Any word. Your own name, or a simple greeting. Not out loud, unless you wish to. Simply in imagination. Letting the pathway rehearse itself.

CLOSING · RETURN

Begin to let the imagery settle. Let it soften. Return attention to the breath — slow, easy, uncomplicated.

Notice what is present in the body now. Perhaps a warmth in the throat or face. Perhaps simply a quietness. Whatever is here, it is the right response.

Take three full breaths — in through the nose, out through the mouth, slowly. Let each breath out carry the practice into the body, into the nervous system, into the pathways you have just rehearsed.

When you are ready — in your own time, without hurry — allow your eyes to open gently. Return to the room.

That is the practice. It takes less than fifteen minutes. It asks nothing of you except your attention and your willingness to imagine. Both of those are enough.

Pathway: Broca's area (left inferior frontal gyrus) → motor speech cortex → cranial nerves VII (face), X (palate/larynx), XII (tongue) → articulators, with diaphragm and intercostals for breath support.

Free educational resource. Not a medical service. Always work with your clinical team. The three-phase structure is the author's synthesis, not a clinically tested protocol as a unit.